Happy Rotter and the Isoner of Prazkaban
Fortnight ~~Three~~ One at ~~Warthogs~~ Prazkaban

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The story contained within this book is meant to cleverly (or not-so-cleverly, depending on your point of view) parody *Harry Potter*, as well as several other works of fiction. It is not meant to copy them outright, nor is that what it is doing. If you appreciate good humor, then the publisher humbly requests that you not sue.

This book is respectfully dedicated to the memory of the dearly departed Fourth Wall. Rest in peace, old friend. Rest in peace.

Also, to the "A" god, to whom I shall never have to sacrifice.

Also again, to David MacKinnon and Arabella Bould, Happy Rotter's first- and second-biggest fans, respectively. Yes, I've made your attachment to this series a competition. No, I don't feel any remorse about it, at all. Have fun competing, suckers.

Also a third time, to Clara Baur, who came up with the gravel 'n' lard cookies.

Also a fourth time, to the late Alan Rickman, whose image was AI-generated for the Harry Potter *films. Such defilement is inexcusable, Warner Brothers. Really, I'm surprised at you.*

Chapter One

As the big black car drove away from Warthogs' menacing gates, Happy Rotter, a small, unpleasant eleven-year-old boy with black hair and glasses, looked out the window forlornly.

"*sighie!*" he said, in honor of Looney Mooney. Looney Mooney was his crazy classmate (well, *schoolmate*—there were no classes at Warthogs) who had recently been involved in a crazy summoning ritual involving the stolen cheeks of several members of Warthogs faculty and student body. Happy had helped it fail, but nevertheless, Looney Mooney and Professor Snake (the supervisor of the ivy mines and Looney Mooney's colleague in the debacle) had managed to frame Happy for the heinous crimes they had committed, which had gotten Happy sent to Prazkaban. Happy had no inkling of what Prazkaban might be, except that it was a school, and it was far away, and this big black car was on its way to it.

"Yo, bruh, where can ya hook me up with the rizzlers?" said Happy to test the driver. An entire *hour* of driving, and they had said nothing.

"Be patient, hon," came a female voice. "We're almost there."

"Thanks," mumbled Happy unintelligibly.

"What was that, hon?"

"THANKS!" bellowed Happy.

"No need to be so loud, hon."

Happy nodded and shut his trap. The woman was being extraordinarily nice to him—or at least nicer than anyone had been to him in an entire month. You see, for the past month or so, Happy had attended a school called Warthogs, which was horrible, to say the least. There, you didn't work—you performed tasks of menial labor for the school's funds (ever-dwindling, never ceasing to run out). Happy had been forced to mine ivy with his best friend Nor Weasel and not-so-best and not-so-friend Herminey until he had been temporarily expelled. He hoped this would not be the case at this school, but expected the opposite.

"Almost there, hon," came the driver's voice again. "Just a few more miles."

How many miles has it been so far? thought Happy crankily. He asked indirectly by saying, "Like, six or seven?" He then 6-7ed.

All the driver did was chuckle. She didn't say, "I'll whip you into shape!" She didn't say, "WHAT WAS THAT?!" And most importantly—

Happy gasped. "*gaspie!* Surely it's nice at Prazkaban."

"You have nothing to be afraid of, hon," came the reply. Happy gave a relieved grin.

The rest of the car ride passed in silence while the engine rumbled merrily away. It seemed like no time at all before the driver announced:

"We're here, hon. Home sweet home."

There was a loud, menacing scraping noise that Happy could feel penetrate even to his bones. He gulped. "*gulpie!*"

"You can get out now, hon," said the driver a bit forcefully after Happy had said "*gulpie*!" about fifty more times.

As he opened the car door, he was met with several stone steps, upon which a large man with excessive burl stood. He had a long, thin silver ponytail and a severe expression, his arms crossed in front of him.

"Yo," said Happy.

"Do you know who I am, boy?" said the man, voice rumbling like thunder.

"No," said Happy truthfully.

"I am the headmaster of this delightful institution, Delicious Foulmouth. Rumbledoor's told me you've met my delinquent of a son, Codra?"

"*gaspie!*" went Happy. "Yes sir!"

"Very good, I see he taught you the basics in formality. Now, follow me inside. The Welcome Banquet is waiting."

Welcome Banquet?! thought Happy in shock. *Welcome Banquet?!?!?!?!?!?!*

There were several students in the hall gabbing about with their friends (!!). Mr. Foulmouth placed a cold, burly hand on one's shoulder. "Claus," he said severely, "show this young man to the mess hall."

"Yes sir!" said Claus, looking up from the book he was holding. "Right away, sir!" He turned to Happy. "*Young* is a word which here means—"

"Bruh, skibidi rizz!" said Happy, grinning. "No need."

"But—" protested Claus, then stopped and took Happy to the mess hall without another word.

The mess hall was a large, messy hall filled with wooden tables. Happy walked up to one of them and

gave it a *big hug*. "Random lunch table, you are now my new best friend," he said lovingly, shooting a glare at the annoying Claus, who glared back.

"Hey!" came a voice from the table. No—not from the table. Someone was *sitting on it. Someone was sitting on Happy's best friend like it was their business.*

"*grr...*" said Happy under his breath.

"Hey!" came the voice again. "Why are you hugging my true love?"

Happy backed away slowly, seeing that the table was completely covered in mud.

The girl (the origin of the voice) hugged the table in his stead. "I love mud," she said. "Don't ever cross me again. I'm Katherine Malarkey. Remember that name. **Remember that name.**" She fixed him with a stern glare. "Mortals forget, but the mud... it never does."

"OK," said Happy.

"*OK*? how dare you. **How dare you.**" The glare became deeper. "***How dare you. Insolent first-year scum.***"

"I tremble before your all-powerful might, o great master of the universe," said Happy meekly (he had learned this from a *Fortnite* YouTube speedrun; incidentally, the user had been being sarcastic).

"*Much* better." Katherine nodded approvingly and went back to massaging and kissing the table (or, rather, the mud on the table).

"What's her street name?" Happy whispered to Claus once they were about ten feet away.

Claus shrugged. "What's a street name?"

"WHAT'S A—"

"*dunno*," said Claus calmly.

Happy shoved Claus.

Claus did not get up from the floor upon which Happy had shoved him.

"Yo, bruh," Happy said rather nervously, poking him in the shoulder, "You a'aight?"

Claus made no indication that he had heard Happy.

A cold hand found its way to Happy's shoulder. "Very good. You've already eliminated some of your academic competition."

Very good? When he had *killed* Claus? Happy was very confused.

"Now, are you ready to eat?"

"*EAT*" screamed Happy. He hadn't eaten since *Tuesday*.

Delicious chuckled warmly, and handed Happy a steaming hamburger from seemingly nowhere. Happy ate it with great gusto in seconds, then wiped his mouth sloppily and said: "MoAR" in an uncharacteristically deep voice. Delicious chuckled again and produced another hamburger, which Happy ate. He gave a loud belch once he had finished, prompting a third chuckle from Delicious. "Yes, that's right, my boy. Eat up!"

"Where's my broom closet—I mean room?" asked Happy earnestly.

"Right down the hall are the dormitories. Your designated friend will show you to them."

"Who's my designated friend?" asked Happy.

"Why, Serious White, of course!" chuckled Delicious, snapping his fingers. At his side appeared a severe young man with hair that was completely white—*Unblemished Pearl,* if Happy was remembering correctly. Oh, the

paint store... it had been *an entire month* since he had been there last...

"Hello, Happy," said Serious, holding out his hand for Happy to shake. Happy trembled. "Please don't whip me," he whimpered.

"Dude. It's called a handshake. This kid, bruh," said Serious disapprovingly, shaking his head.

Happy brightened at the *bruh* and shook Serious' hand eagerly. "I've only done this, like, six or seven times," he told him.

"6-7!" said Serious, 6-7ing once he had broken free from the handshake, and Happy did the same. Then they fist-bumped.

"C'mon, I'll show you to your room," said Serious.

"Just for me?" asked Happy meekly.

"Yes, just for you. How else would it be?"

With a creak, Serious opened a large door on their left. It led into another hallway, except this one had doors evenly (and well) spaced between them. They had little gold numbers next to them on the plaster wall.

"Welcome home, Happy," said Serious as he handed him a key, leading him to an apartment on the right of the entryway.

Happy inserted the key into the golden doorknob and, after about five minutes of struggling, managed to fit it into the lock and turn it.

"Home sweet home," said Happy, his eyes lighting up at the sight that awaited them. A large, four-poster bed with fluffy sheets and curtains. A large, luxurious window. And—best of all—a *school-issued, straight-from-factory laptop.*

Happy rushed to open it up. There was a Post-It® note on it, reading: YOUR USERNAME IS [redacted] AND YOUR PASSWORD IS [redacted]. Happy entered this information into the laptop.

And then he signed into TikTok—for the first time in a month—and doom-scrolled for three hours because for some reason it was unblocked.

But, as he doom-scrolled...

Happy

realized something.

He was hot. Very hot. He just couldn't get comfortable. And when it was hot...

When it was hot, his skin began to flake more than normal.

Happy could feel pieces of his forehead already beginning to crust. "*gaspie!*" he cried, touching it in dismay only to have a small chunk of flesh come off in his hand! He looked wildly around for a dial to turn down (or at least a mini fridge in which he could hide—I told you he was small) but there was nothing.

His fingers (excepting one of his pinkies, which the loyal reader will recall was already bereft of flesh) began to flake as well. Trembling, Happy began to sweat, which only made it worse.

There was a rap on the door. "Happy, may I come in?" He recognized it immediately as the voice of Serious White, and got up from the side of his luxurious bed. "Totally, bruh." He had to try really hard to keep his voice from shaking, and he failed.

Serious opened the door, one hand behind his back. "What's wrong with you, bruh?"

"Nuttin' much, what's wrong with you, bro bruh?" Happy responded as usual, grinning, and forgetting all about the urgent situation happening with his skin.

Serious' hand emerged from behind his back to reveal: a cake! With maraschino

cherries—Happy's favorite—on it! "Eat up, little bro," he said, smiling, and brought it to Happy, who devoured it in fifty-six gulps, chomping and smacking (Happy's mother never quite had the heart to reprimand him for poor table manners). He licked his lips vigorously upon completion.

"This kid, bruh," said Serious. "See ya later." He went back to the door.

"*gaspie!*" cried Happy. *Did he just say seeyalaytur*? You see, a *seeyalaytur* was Professor Snake's ancestor, a rare and dangerous snake from Parts Unknown. Serious, however, did not look back.

There was a slight *chink* as he jiggled the doorknob shut. It had never made that noise before. Happy rushed to the door to catch up with Serious and ask him whether he really did mean what he said about the *seeyalaytur*. But as his sweaty, flaking fingers gripped the doorknob, he realized...

Serious had locked it.

Happy, in desperation, looked on his bed, where he had left the keys. But they were gone. Serious had stolen them, and locked him in his room.

Happy sweated and trembled even more, making his skin flake even faster. You could almost *watch* it curling off, if you watched closely.

It was becoming painful. Happy seized the end of one flake and ripped it off his skin, wincing. Blood welled up in the aftermath and a blister began to form. He looked around for a Band-Aid®, but there was none, none at all. He raided the mini-fridge, but there was none. Even his luxurious bathroom (which was devoid of skincare supplies excepting a towel) had no Band-Aid®s. Happy began to hyperventilate. *I should go on TikTok,* he thought through his terror. *TikTok will help calm me down.*

So he did.

DO YOU HAVE JOKK ICH?

TREATMENTS FOR RINWURM.

HOW TO DEAL WITH YOUR WEAPING EXCSZEMA.

SIMPLE HOME REMEDIES TO KEEP YOUR SKIN LOOKING LIKE IT DID WHEN YOU WERE ELEVEN YEARS OLD!

Happy clicked on them all in desperation, trying to find something—*anything*—to help him. But there was nothing.

More skin fell off, causing more blisters. "Ow ow ow..." Happy cried, clutching his skin as more flakes burst forth.

It had become too much for the flesh on his his middle fingers. They had called it quits, as blisters had formed under them. They fell on the floor.

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy in terror—which of his fingers would be next? The observant (and loyal) reader will notice that this "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" contains one less "A" than before. Happy is growing more tolerant!

Deep breath! In... out! he thought desperately, a mantra oft-chanted by his elementary school counselor, Mrs. Kilmer. Mrs. Kilmer was not kind, and not nice, as the other grown-ups at the school would have had him believe. She was often the sweaty grown-up in a broccoli costume at school assemblies during Happy's fifth-grade year. Oh, how he and Nor had jeered at her and her bouncy curls. Oh, for the happy carefree days of youth! Happy sighed—"*sighie!*"—and tapped the seven fingers he had left against the window. *That's what Looney Mooney would say*

if she were here. And what would Herminey say? "You can still mine, get back to work?" He allowed himself a bitter chuckle. *But they're not here, they're at Warthogs, and Nor is too. Everyone's at Warthogs, and here I am, all alone at Prazkaban with Katherine Malarkey and Serious White and Delicious Foulmouth. How did we get to this point? My friends! My friends! Where are you? Warthogs? Warthogs! I must get back to Warthogs!* thought Happy desperately. *I must escape from Prazkaban! I MUST see Nor again!*

Strengthening his resolve, Happy curled his right fist, walked over to the window and gave it a *big hug*.

"Yo, bruh," he told it. "Wanna unlock and lemme out? I'll starve."

The window did not budge.

"Yo, c'mon! Be a bro!"

Still, no movement from the window.

"Bruh, seriously? This is *so* not sigma." Happy scowled at the window. The window had no reaction to this display of derision.

"Emotional damage!" whined Happy (in the specific syllable emphasis the YouTubers used!) and left the window to its own devices, retreating to his school computer. He watched

YouTube videos about Clash Royale for about three hours, then he played Clash Royale for five more hours, forgetting all the time that 1) it was well past midnight and 2) his skin was flaking and falling off like crazy.

Eventually, he crashed out from exhaustion and disconcertion, and tiredness. So many fatiguing events had occurred within the frame of the day, and Happy was ready to clamber into his own coffin and close it with one of his mutilated hands. But it wasn't his time, not yet—the author had to keep him alive at least until the end of the last book in the series, and this—sad to say—was not it.

Happy awoke thirty-seven and a quarter minutes later to a knocking on his door. It was the same knock Serious had used the previous night. "Yo, little bro! What's wrong with you?" came his cordial voice.

"Nuttin' much, what's wrong with you?" croaked a groggy Happy.

Serious laughed. "Time for brekkie, bro. Don't wan' be late!" He entered the room and ripped the covers off of Happy's small figure. Happy screamed "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" indignantly.

"Don' be that way, bruh," protested Serious. "That is *so* not sigma."

Happy shut up at once. Screaming not sigma? He made a solemn vow right then and there not to scream as long as he was at Prazkaban. He got out of bed and followed Serious mutely out his door.

"Yo," he began tentatively as they passed dormitory after luscious dormitory. "Whyddya say *seeyalaytur?*"

Serious looked at him. "Are you serious right now, bruh?"

"No, but you are," said Happy.

"Ha, ha. Very funny," deadpanned Serious. "*See you later* means that I'll be seeing you later, not that we're parting for good."

"But—it's a very rare and very dangerous snake...?!" protested Happy.

"Nah, bruh," explained Serious. "Whoever told you that was 'yanking your chain'."

"Wazzat?"

Serious massaged his brow. "Oh, would you look at that! We're at the mess hall!"

The hall was alive with chatter and clatter. Happy struggled to find a seat as his designated friend had darted away to be with cooler people. He eventually found a vacant

seat next to—who else?—Katherine Malarkey. In fact, her entire table was vacant save for her and a deluge of mud on the other side.

Happy sat down next to her and attempted to make small talk: "Uh, yo! What's wrong with you?"

"Nothing, thank you *very* much," said Katherine shortly. "Wanna leave, or lose a limb?"

I have to get out of here, thought Happy desperately. "Er."

"Lose a limb it is!" chirped Katherine and lunged for his thigh. Happy slapped her hand away, screaming "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" for help in spite of himself. He blushed. "Sorry. I know that's not sigma."

"Who cares," said Katherine, "it's a departure or a sudden dearth of appendages."

Happy had no idea what the words *departure, dearth* and *appendages* meant, but he left the table. As he left he heard Katherine give a sigh of relief. "He looks so much like Pita, doesn't he, Mud?"

He shook his head. "Weirdo. This kid, bruh." even though Katherine was much older than he was.

Slumping in a corner, Happy sighed dramatically as he had seen in the trailer for an anime while scrolling on Netflix. The trailers were always stupid on Netflix and they never told you much about the film. Happy preferred the Prime Video trailers as they were almost always theatrical; he even sampled one from 1944. But that was home, half a world away. If only he were back at home with his ma. If only he were back at Warthogs with Nor and Herminey and everybody.

I have to get out of here, thought Happy. He began consuming pancakes with great globs of maple syrup.

Chapter Two

On his way out the door from the mess hall, Happy was stopped by Serious, who shoved a piece of paper in his hands. Happy, who hadn't read anything for quite a while, was quite confused until he remembered learning the basics. His first period, according to the paper, was Physical Education. The room number was 28, and Happy had the common sense to check the room numbers of the surrounding doors in the hallway and so arrived at the gym without much difficulty.

"Hello, friends," boomed a voice from the loudspeakers. Happy didn't see any grown-up, although he did see several other children milling about in the gym. "Are you ready to get moving?" The students cheered and Happy followed suit.

"We will now begin the push-up section." Immediately, everyone around Happy got into push-up position. He did the same. "Remember, this activity is OPTIONAL. Down... up; one. Down... up; two. Down... up; three. Down... up; four. Down... up; five.

Happy's arms immediately broke into a sweat as he hoisted himself up from the ground again and again. He took two *down*...

*up*s to get one push-up, and his stomach hit the ground each time. It was hot in the room, and Happy began to sweat.

When Happy sweated, as you'll recall, his skin began to flake more than normal.

And this time, it was his arms what was the target. They were so hot and tired they became itchy. Happy made a rash decision and stopped *down*... *up*ing to scratch them. And scratch them. And scratch them. Before Happy knew, quite a bit of both skin and flesh had been scratched off his arms and first period was over. The most athletic of the children, called Jonah, was still pushing up at 140. "*gaspie*!" said Happy in admiration, going closer to give Jonah a high-five. "What's wrong with you, bruh? I only did, like, six or seven."

"6-7!" said Jonah and 6-7ed. Happy beamed and 6-7ed right back.

Happy's next class, according to the piece of paper, was Shepherding 101. He was quite curious as to what this class entailed.

He opened the door to the classroom for a nasty boy behind him who told him his car was so fat, it could fit people in it. He retorted with "Your car is so old, it runs on gas!",

which shut him up—to be Frank, Happy's mother's car also ran on gas, but Nor's didn't. It was a cybertruck, a purple cybertruck. Happy had a disturbing flashback to three weeks ago (*was it three weeks? it seemed like years)* when that purple cybertruck had pulled up first to the imposing Warthogs gates. (*happy had tried to warn them oh, how he had tried but it was to no avail)*

Happy shook his head. His mind was getting really loud. He went through the door.

and was immediately struck in the chest by a rampaging sheep!

"*sheeple deeple!*" cried Happy, rubbing his chest in pain.

"They do that sometimes," came a voice. "Don't mind it, or you'll wind up losing your nose."

The voice belonged to Serious White. "*gaspie!*" said Happy. "Do you have this class, also?"

"Why yes," said Serious jovially. "And so do my friends here, don't we boys?" He cackled as several other teenage boys—sweaty, hairy, smelly—appeared behind him. He did their secret handshake.

"Oioi!" said Happy suddenly, watching them. "That's *my* handshake—*our* handshake—me an' Nor—we—"

Serious and his friends were bumping tummies. "Not anymore, little bro," said Serious, "not anymore."

Happy glowered.

"Cwass cwass!" came a voice from the center of the room.

"YES YES!" came a thundering response from around the classroom, Happy included. His fifth-grade teacher had loved that attention-getter.

"Chewdoi..." The teacher looked around the room. "Wee wiww bee dowin' ower furst SHEAP HURD."

A cheer went up around the room. "Finally," Happy heard Serious exclaim quietly in delight, "a chance to show off my mad skillzzz!" He made a dorky pose that Happy thought was very cool. It wasn't. It was just dorky. Happy, however, had nothing but admiration for Serious and so went "*gaspie!*" and bowed down all the same.

"CWASS, CWASS!" said the teacher loudly, trying to stop all the murmuring, but

he did this in vain. The children just would not shut up.

"Fow thowz of yew who hawv noh hurd'd sheap beefoar, itsh kwite eashee." The teacher was almost yelling to be heard over the uproar of students pointing out which sheep they wanted to herd, and the sheep were no better—they were bleating like mad. "Havv wan of the odur schudunts teech yu. Git chew work."

The class cheered and ran to a closet as one for the student canes. (Happy knew they were student canes because it said so on the cabinet: STUDENT CANES.)

Happy got the last one. It was shiny blue and had wood lice.

One of the wood lice bit his hand. Happy screamed "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" in pain. The observant reader will notice that this "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" contains one less "A" than before. Happy is growing more tolerant!

"Yo," said another wood louse. "Wuz good, bro?"

Happy looked down at his bleeding hand. "Not this."

"We can fix that for you, bro. Chill! It's not sigma to scream."

Happy almost fainted in front of the wood louse. How dare he say that screaming was not sigma! He recalled Serious saying something similar before, but had paid very little if any attention to it.

The wood louse made an odd screeching noise, causing several other wood lice to come out of the cane. "Yo," greeted the second wood louse, who appeared to be the leader of the lot. "This bro needs help. Can I get an 'S'?"

"S!"

"Can I get an 'E'?"

"E!"

"An' can I get an...er...a 'W'?"

"W!"

"What does that spell?"

"SEW!"

"Very good! Now, get some thread and a needle."

Happy gulped. A needle? "*gulpie!*"

The needle was very small and the thread supply was small, but somehow with minimal

"*gaspie*!"s of pain from Happy, the injury was sewn up in no time.

"Thank you, Mr. Wood Louse," said Happy, who had—somehow—remembered his very little manners.

"The name's Filbert," said the wood louse, "and wood lice are completely different creatures, and besides it's considered a slur in our community. We say 'pill bug' now. Or 'potato bug', or 'roly-poly', but those are far less formal and considered to be used only for those of our kind."

"OK," said Happy placidly. "Thank you, Mr. Pill Bug."

"Much better." The wood louse—er, *pill bug*—nodded approvingly. "We're at your service should you ever require our aid."

"Thank you." Happy blinked, stunned, as Filbert and his colony retreated into the cane. "*blinkie!*" blinked Happy. Then Autocorrect changed "*blinkie!*" to "*blankie!*"; however, when typed again, it caught on and didn't change it any further.

"I'mma go catch me some sheep!" muttered Happy to himself, clutching his sewn-up hand in the other.

The sheep were not easy to catch. They ran around the halls of Prazkaban and made it quite difficult, even bursting into the other classrooms. Finally, in the gym, Happy cornered one with the help of a girl called Maddy who kept insisting her name was pronounced "Maudie".

"Thanks, Maddy," whispered Happy to her as he marked the sheep with his special edible sheep sticker (edible in case the wool ended up being used as food for Warthogs, Happy knew it was something Herminey would eat if she was desperate. You see the sheep were shipped out to Warthogs once they got old, to be eaten by the students. It was considered a special treat every two months or so. However, Happy hadn't attended Warthogs for two months yet, so he hadn't had a chance to enjoy this delicacy).

"I told you," hissed Maddy, "it's *Maudie!* Is that so hard?"

"Yes, it is, Maddy. I'm sorry, Maddy," said Happy apologetically.

Maddy punched him.

"Schwedints," came a voice from the hall, and the teacher entered the room. "Vylinss is

mowst empawtheticklee *nawt inkurridged* at Prazkaban."

"Now look what you've done!" growled Maddy at Happy. "You've gone and gotten me in trouble."

"Sorry, Maddy," whispered Happy. "I'll do better next time, Maddy."

"*AAAAAAAAAAAAAAA!*" screamed Maddy in anger. She was naturally more tolerant than Happy, hence the fewer "A"s.

"Now, now, Maudie, let'sh not may'k a fuss," reprimanded the teacher, whose name Happy still had not learned.

"*He called me Maddy!*" Maddy seethed. "*He called me Maddy!*"

"Cawlm daun, deer," soothed the teacher, "he's jawst insensitiv."

"*Just insensitive*, my butt!" screamed Maddy.

"I'm sorry, Maddy, I don't know what I did, Maddy," said Happy.

Maddy made another lunge for Happy, which the teacher averted by stepping between the children. "Naiuh, naiuh," he said. "Ai dohn't think we've been pwoperwy intwadushed, Meesta Rotta. Mai nem is

Pwofessa Quarrel, hedd aw thuh shepherding depawtmint heer at Fow—er, Pwazkabon."

Fow? Happy wondered what this could have meant. "OK, Mr. Quarrel."

"*Pwofessah*, mai deah boi. *Pwofessah*."

"OK, Mr. Quarrel."

"Dhat's a *dee-ten-shun* foah you, mai deah boi."

"OK, Mr. Quarrel." He turned to Maddy. "I really am sorry, Maddy."

"*AAAAAAAAAAAAAAA!*" Maddy and Professor Quarrel screamed as one.

Chapter Three

Happy managed to herd the sheep into the classroom with the help of the ~~wood lice~~ pill bugs, who pointed it in the right direction.

When he arrived at the shepherding classroom, however, he realized that his sheep haul was the meagerest of the lot; even Brandy Jane, dweeb extraordinaire, had caught at least two.

"LOSER!" she cried, pointing at him with one hand and making the "L" sign on her forehead with the other. She did the Loser Dance. Brandy Jane was very happy to find someone even worse at shepherding than she was. Happy frowned. It felt bad to be the butt of the joke, he thought, or any sort of butt.

Serious had herded "like, six or seven," Happy heard him saying to his friends.

"Bro, that's so fire!" said Happy, coming up to him.

"Outta my way, loser," said Serious coldly, shoving him into a sheep called Jeff.

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy.

"BAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" bleated a terrified Jeff.

Happy blinked—"*blinkie!*"—and Autocorrect finally realized that I never want to type "*blankie!*" when Happy blinks. "Hiya, sheepie." He tried to pat Jeff's head.

"BAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" bleated Jeff for absolutely no reason at all. Happy jumped back in terror. He decided he didn't like Jeff.

The students all lined up to put their canes back. Happy ran to put the cane somewhere he would remember well. He didn't want to lose the wood li—*pill bugs*, sorry.

He put it in the very corner, where no one else would see it.

Then it was time, finally, for third period: according to Happy's schedule, this was maths in room 3.14159. Happy hated math, and he wasn't very sure he would enjoy the plural version, either.

The teacher of maths had a British accent, accounting for the plurals. She, much to Happy's relief, did not use attention-getters.

"Hello, *children*," she said nastily once everyone was seated. "Would you enjoy doing some *pre-algebra?*"

Grumbling, moaning, shaking of heads. No one enjoyed doing pre-algebra, except Brandy

Jane, dweeb extraordinaire, who eagerly put up her hand and shook it in a thumbs-up. "YES! YES!! YES!!!"

"Very good, Brandy Jane," said the teacher, smiling. Brandy Jane, teacher's pet, returned the smile. "You and you alone will have homework today."

"*Yesss!*" Brandy Jane, dweeb extraordinaire, pumped her fist. "*Yesss!*"

I like Brandy Jane, dweeb extraordinaire, more and more. Perhaps I will force her to be in other books, as well.

"Today, we'll be learning about how to find the circumference of a circle. Remember, the formula is πr^2..."

Happy didn't know how to find the area of a circle! Happy barely knew how to do long division! At his elementary school, he'd had a D- in math! He quickly turned to his shoulder partner for help.

His shoulder partner was

Brandy Jane, dweeb extraordinaire.

"Oh, of course!" gushed Brandy Jane, who of course had already finished the worksheet. "I'd be *thrilled* to help you! OK, so this problem, the radius (r) is 3 feet, right? So you

square it—that's what that little 2 is over it, you multiply it *by itself*, which brings us to 9. Then you multiply *that* by π—which is ***3.14159265358979323846264338327950288419716939937510582097494459230781640628620899862803482534211706***7 (well, that's all I've memorized at least, sorry), but we'll simplify that to 3.14, *of course*—which brings us to the solution: 28.26 feet!" She smiled, pleased with herself. "There you go! You've solved it! Good job! Now write down the answer there, on the line. Happy? Happy, are you listening, you loser?"

Happy was not listening. Happy was playing a game of "Steal a Brainrot" in his head. He always did that when he got overwhelmed or confused.

"Happy!" groaned Brandy Jane, dweeb extraordinaire, waving a hand in front of his eyes. "Come on! You think I'm interesting! You think I'm interesting!! Surely you think I'm interesting!!!"

Happy blinked. Happy grinned.

"Don't call me Shirley!" he said, reaching for a whip that wasn't there. He felt a pang. He missed Warthogs. He missed Nor. And

maybe even missed Hermi—*no*. He did *not* miss Herminey.

"So what should I call you?" asked Brandy Jane snootily.

"The name's Rotter," said Happy in a deep voice. "Happy Rotter."

"Right then, Rotter, Happy Rotter," said Brandy Jane.

"I didn't mean it that way!" protested Happy. "It's a reference to the James Bond movies. You know, double-oh-seven and all that!" He began to hum the James Bond theme song (or what he *thought* was the theme song—it was actually the *Mission Impossible* theme song).

"You dummy," said Brandy Jane. Taking on a buffoonish voice to impersonate Happy, she said, "That's a reference to the *Mission Impossible* franchise. You know, Ethan Hunt and all that!"

"What does *franchise* mean?" asked Happy.

"Why am I hanging out with *you*, stupid?" fired back Brandy Jane. "Shut up and get to work!" She put her thumb and pointer finger on her forehead in an "L" shape and wiggled her body around in her best approximation of

the loser dance whilst her legs were trapped under her desk.

You're the real loser, you dweeb, thought Happy angrily, making a mental note to ask Serious what "franchise" meant.

He had forgotten all about the mental note by the time class ended, instead playing "Steal a Brainrot" in his head again and getting absolutely zero work done on his worksheet. The only completed problem he had was the one Brandy Jane had completed for him.

He followed Brandy Jane out the door as they were dismissed by desk rows and their desks were right next to each other (you see, Happy sat by the wall and Brandy Jane next to him, in the very back; this was how come he was unable to ask anyone other than Brandy Jane for help). Their worksheets had to be shown and turned in to the teacher, who was waiting at the doorway to check the worksheets and give Brandy Jane, teacher's pet, her homework. As she studied Brandy Jane's worksheet, she *tsk*ed. "Brandy Jane, that's extra homework for you. You didn't show any of your work!"

Happy sucked in a breath through his teeth, making an annoying noise Nor's mother often

made when Nor whined for something and didn't get it, then whined about not getting it. "That's what you get for whining," she'd say to him.

Nor. Happy's best friend. He needed him. Happy needed Nor.

Brandy Jane, teacher's pet, apologized profusely for committing this grievous crime, and was not forgiven, instead given another sheet of homework in the shape of a dunce cap. Happy could have sworn he saw her shed a few tears as she left wearing the cap.

Then it was his turn to face the teacher's scrutinizing eye. She looked at his paper, took it from him, threw it in the trash and shoved him hostilely out the door.

That was mean, thought Happy sadly as he trudged into the bustling hallways of Prazkaban.

His fourth period, it turned out, was Science in Room 62 with Dr. Philo, a tall old man with a wispy beard and long, silky white hair.

"Hello, children," he said as they took their (random) seats (Happy couldn't find anyone to sit with so he just chose a random place to sit). "Are you ready to learn the *Secrets*" (his

voice echoed here; he was speaking into a microphone dangling from the squat ceiling) "*of the Universe?*" (This also echoed.)

"YES!" echoed the class. Happy was too late.

"Today," said Dr. Philo, "we'll be learning how to make plutonium from common household items."

"Hooray!" cheered the class. Happy, once again, was too late.

In a procedure I am legally barred from explaining (there were some legally and morally questionable techniques utilized, and all the children were forced to wear ill-fitting HAZMAT suits), the plutonium was created and contained in a large steel cask. "Thanks to you," said Dr. Philo as they left, "I'm one step closer to controlling the universe." He grinned cheerily at Happy as he left, and he returned the smile.

It was 12:34, which meant "lunch for all Prazkaban isoners!—er, students!"; or so proclaimed Delicious Foulmouth's voice from the loudspeaker. Happy gasped in delight and sprinted towards the cafeteria, but was so dreadfully out of shape he was seventy-ninth—last—in line for hot dogs, right behind

Brandy Jane, dweeb extraordinaire.

"Hi, Rotter, Happy Rotter," she said to annoy him.

"Hi, Jane, Brandy Jane," he retorted, mimicking her smarmy tone. "What's that on your face—grape jelly?"

"For *your* FYI," said Brandy Jane, "there's nothing on my face other than my pure, natural beauty." She smiled, showing Happy her aquamarine braces.

"Woah," said Happy, "how beautiful you are, Brandy Jane."

"I know, right?" said Brandy Jane, giggling.

Happy nodded as if he agreed with her. He believed Brandy Jane to be the ugliest dweeb he had ever met. And Happy had seen his fair share of ugly dweebs. There's me, for one.

The hot dogs had little specks on them. They tasted like the crusty skin on Happy's lips. Crammed next to Katherine Malarkey (every other seat was full), Happy ate his in 0.5 seconds, then closed his eyes and played a calming game of "Steal a Brainrot" in his head.

He used to play that game with Nor.

I have to get out of this school, thought Happy. *I have to get back to Warthogs. No matter what.*

Chapter Four

Happy's fifth period was English. English was in the second building they'd constructed after the "expansion and rebran—" of the school, as Serious White explained to him as they walked to class. Serious was obligated to explain this to him, and anyways he also had a class in the second building. Happy wondered what "rebran—" meant, and asked Serious as much, but his only answer was: "Never mind." He then loped away from Happy in big, strong bounds.

"Hey," called Happy as Serious ran away, "hey, what does *franchise* mean?"

Not receiving a response, He shrugged and proceeded to walk across the grassy field separating the two school buildings.

The second building was considerably cooler than that of the main campus, and Happy exhaled in relief. His skin had been flaking away all morning.

His English class was in room 87 and Happy nearly skipped all the way there. But what was to meet him at the door but the stern face of a middle-aged woman.

"Hi!" said Happy cheerfully (he was in a good mood).

"Hi," said the woman back to Happy. "Take your seat, dear."

"No!" said Happy cheerfully (he was in an argumentative mood).

"That's nice, dear, I'm sure you won't, dear," said the woman, patting him on the head. "Go on, now, here's your book, we're going to read it in class and then answer some comprehension questions."

"OK," said Happy, taking the book she was handing out. The cover was purple and brown, and it had some shiny letters on the cover. "H-A," spelled out Happy, "I-R-Y. That spells, *Hairy*." The golden letters were kind of hard to make out due to their highly stylized nature, but Happy was able to decipher the rest: P-O-T-T-Y-E-R.

"Very good, dear." The woman patted his head approvingly. "Now, take your seat."

"OK." Happy took his seat, which was right next to

Jonah, from first period.

"What's crackin', bro?" said Jonah.

"Only ate, like, six or seven hot dogs at lunch," said Happy.

"6-7!" said Jonah and 6-7ed. Happy followed suit, grinning.

"Settle down, darlings," said the woman (the teacher, Happy surmised). "We're going to start a new book today." She held a book up from behind her back. "*Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone!* Isn't that nice, darlings?"

Hairy Potter? thought Happy. *Who is this guy and how much hair does he have? Must be a lot if he's named for his hair.* (It's important to note that Happy was not a very well-read young man in the slightest.)

"This book is copyright two thousand and twenty-six[1] by—" the teacher squinted at the

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[1] This copyright notice now says 1997, but this is a lie. In truth, that lady has plagiarized this series. If anyone's reading this, you have to know several important things:

1. Beyond the first book, every *Harry Potter* book is AI-generated drivel. **Slop**. That is why you have learned about their being burned. If you have any copies in your home, I encourage you to build a bonfire outside *this second* and **burn them.**
2. Everything you know about "Daniel Radcliffe", "Rupert Grint" and "Emma Watson" are **lies**. They are **AI-GENERATED ACTORS.** Similarly, Alan Rickman (who plays this "Professor Snape"—who names their kid *Snape*? Come on!) is indeed dead, but his image was AI-generated for the films; this was

small print on the copyright notice. "*JK Rowling*! Goodness, we're one of the first people to ever read this book, darlings! The publisher sent the whole school an ARC!" (For those who don't read Goodreads reviews all the $#@&ing time, *ARC* stands for Advance Reader's Copy—they're flimsily printed paperbacks sent to reviewers in the hope of favorable word). "Chapter One," began the teacher. "Mr and Mrs Dursley of

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to give them a sense of period authenticity. I have to hand it to the Warner Brothers. Genius, really. But the shameless plagiarism of my work is something I simply ***cannot*** stand for.

3. The fond childhood memories you have of reading and/or watching the *Harry Potter* series? **Lies**, also. **They were fabricated and sent to your mind via supersonic BRAIN WAVES through the bird drones situated near your home town.**
4. *Harry Potter* is in fact a clever parody of *Happy Rotter*. Wake up.
5. **I am not making this up.**
6. If you need proof: "JK" Rowling. You know what that "JK" stands for? Not "Joanne Kathleen", as you've been taught. Oh, no. That "JK" stands for "Just Kidding".

number four, Privet Drive, were proud to say that they were perfectly normal, thank you very much..." Happy zoned out and studied the stamps on the copy he was holding in his hands (for the textbooks had to be returned to *somewhere*).They read thus:



The location of Prazkaban is classified; therefore, I have been forced to remove the address from the book. But have faith. One day the full tale may be told.

The teacher finished the chapter—the story was *quite* dull, about grown-ups and magic and whatever, and yet Happy found himself intrigued against his better judgement.

Then, she handed out *worksheets.*

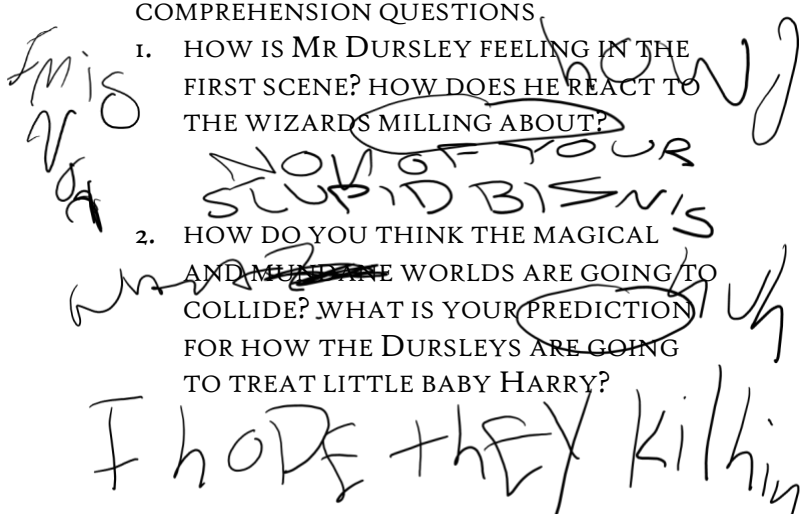
"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy. The observant reader will notice that this "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" contains one less "A" than before. Happy is growing more tolerant!—much to the chagrin of everyone else in the room.

"Yo," groaned several other boys as one, "that is *so* not sigma!"

Happy gasped, scandalized. "*gaspie!*" He then rebutted with: "Your movie's so fat, it was filmed for IMAX!" which shut them up pretty good. He looked down at his worksheet.

Here is what it said, at the end, with Happy's answers:

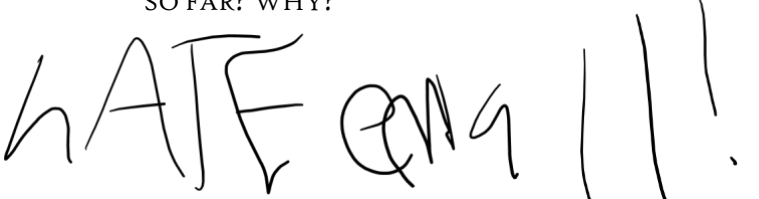
COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS



1. HOW IS MR DURSLEY FEELING IN THE FIRST SCENE? HOW DOES HE REACT TO THE WIZARDS MILLING ABOUT?

2. HOW DO YOU THINK THE MAGICAL AND ~~MUNDANE~~ WORLDS ARE GOING TO COLLIDE? WHAT IS YOUR PREDICTION FOR HOW THE DURSLEYS ARE GOING TO TREAT LITTLE BABY HARRY?

3. WHO IS YOUR FAVOURITE CHARACTER SO FAR? WHY?



It's important to note that Happy was not a very well-read young man in the slightest.

Eventually the bell rang and Happy left for his last class.

Or did he?

No. He didn't.

Instead of going to sixth period—Esperanto—he headed west of the separate building.

Happy was going to escape from Prazkaban.

Chapter Four

Happy ran and ran and ran. He ran so fast his little legs almost gave out. His belly flopped from below his panting head.

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA!" screamed Happy in delight at the thought of getting back to Warthogs where there was Nor and Hairy Otter and Ronald ~~and~~ & Donald (don't neglect the ampersand!) and—oh, Warthogs, Warthogs, warty hoggy Warthogs!

As soon as he reached the school gates, however, he felt a cold hand on the back of his shoulder.

"I think you and I ought to have a talk, oughtn't we, dear boy?"

"What's *oughtn't*?" asked Happy as Delicious Foulmouth led him away from the hastily repainted school gates.

Before they left, however, Happy heard a *click-click-click...*

Delicious Foulmouth's office was located in a small, desolate part of the main building. Happy gulped in fear as he was led into it.

The office was without a door. It looked as if the door had been pulled from its hinges and put somewhere else.

"Yo," said Happy, "that's sus."

"It's a remnant of this wonderful institution's insidious past," explained Delicious. "The door was defenestrated."

"What's *defenestrated*?" asked Happy.

"Thrown from the window. Now take a seat, my *dear, dear boy*." The words came out forced.

Happy took a seat by the legs and ran out of the room.

Immediately before he passed through the doorway, a long array of spikes shot down from the top of it. There was a disturbing amount of sticky chartreuse residue on them.

"Stay and talk awhile, my dear boy," commanded Delicious. This time Happy didn't argue. He dragged his chair up to Delicious' desk and braced himself for the inevitable lecture.

Delicious let out a long, wailing screech. It echoed throughout the room, making Happy flinch and cover his ears.

This is the perfect time for this precise eventuality, because the "E" god is displeased with me. You may now receive the gift of "E" from their benevolent, loving arms.

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Gee, that was a lot of "E"s. I sure hope you haven't died from overexposure to sounds of "E".

"What was that?" Happy cried in alarm.

"That," said Delicious viciously, "is the Foulmouth heritage, my dear, dear boy." He opened his mouth wide and Happy braced himself for another screech.

It didn't come. He instead bit Happy gently on the shoulder.

"A single bite is all it takes," said Delicious, "to become infected with the madness. We'll place you in the Think Tank till you lose your sanity. And, Happy?"

Happy trembled in fear. There was a dark swirl in his stomach, he could feel it getting

larger and larger and larger and larger

"Have this hamburger." Delicious pulled a hamburger from his pocket, which he then handed to Happy. He then pulled some keys from his pocket and unlocked what Happy had previously assumed to be a closet door, but **wasn't.** Instead, a cool blue chamber lay in front of Happy.

I have to get out of here, thought Happy as he took large, messy bites of the hamburger. He

then dropped to the floor, unconscious. The last thing he was aware of was Delicious screeching again, in triumph.

The next thing Happy knew, he was chained to the wall. It was cold. "I'm cold," he whined.

"I'm sure you are," came a voice from the other side of the wall.

Happy recognized that voice.

"Brandy Jane?"

"Yes, I need someone to bully, so I came to see what was happening to you," explained Brandy Jane. "Now I can molest you without any fear of your fighting back." Happy couldn't see her, but he could hear the sadistic smile in her voice. "So. Who wants to do my pre-algebra homework?"

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy.

He heard her footsteps fading, to be replaced by that of a sheep. *Jeff*, thought Happy in disdain.

Jeff broke the door down.

"Thank you, Jeff!" cried Happy, not remembering that there was no door! Happy was dreaming!

Happy woke up in the holding cell, locked closed by Delicious Foulmouth.

There was a small paper on his ball and chain. The paper read thus:

FORCEPS SCHOOL FOR INCURABLES



Huh, thought Happy. *I've seen that address before. And heard that name. Forceps... Forceps... was that where Dad went to school? I think I've seen those numbers sooner... maybe Mr. Foulmouth got it on loan from there?* Happy wondered.

There was a sound of a key being turned in a lock and Happy was released from the chamber. But by what?

He didn't check to see before racing back to the cafeteria for supper.

"Yo," said the lunch lady as he entered, eliciting a sunny beam from Happy. "The food's kaput."

"What's that mean?" asked Happy. "That's sus, bruh."

"We're all out of food, stupid!"

"Callin' me stupid is so not sigma, bruh," said Happy. The lunch lady didn't care.

"Come back tomorrow when we're not so swamped," she said.

"OK," said Happy. "You got it, boss."

The lunch lady growled. "Don't call me boss."

"Surely it doesn't insult you that much!"

"Of course it does!"

"Bruh, I just called you Shirley!" taunted Happy.

"Shirley is my sister. She went by Shirley Anne," said the lunch lady.

"What happened to her?" asked Happy.

"I cooked for her."

"Oh."

"Get your a— out of here!" said the lunch lady, her specific cuss drowned out by the thunder of Happy's footsteps running away and into his dormitory.

Who should he meet there but

Brandy Jane, dweeb extraordinaire.

"Hi!" she said. "There's been a rooming change, with the new students. I'm your new roommate!"

Chapter Five

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy. The observant reader will notice that this "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" contains one less "A" than before. Happy is growing more tolerant!

"Do you have a screaming problem or something?" asked Brandy Jane. "Go to sleep. I already put on my whale sounds! You're interrupting my whale sounds!!"

"Surely it doesn't matter that much," said Happy as a test.

"In fact it *does*," said Brandy Jane. "I can't sleep without 'em. They're shown to have a positive effect on the brain and promote a better night's sleep. But you wouldn't know anything about that. By the way, I did you the pleasure of destroying your laptop. That's the first test."

"What test?"

"To see if you're really incurable."

"Why would they want to know if I'm... what's that word, bruh?"

"Cut the slang. *Incurable*? Can't be cured? Dummy." She slugged him.

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy.

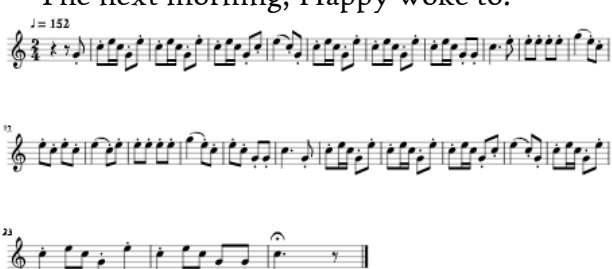
"There are two more tests, but I'm not gonna tell you about them," said Brandy Jane. "I don't help losers any more than they need."

"What do you mean?" asked Happy.

"Losers like YOU!" said Brandy Jane. "Now shut up and let me listen to my whale sounds!"

Happy scowled at her, squeezed his pillow over his ears in a futile attempt to drown out the whale sounds, and went to sleep.

The next morning, Happy woke to:



Brandy Jane was on the bugle. "Get up, loser, or you'll miss breakfast."

"Hungry," said Happy.

"That's nice, dear," said Brandy Jane in a condescending tone of voice. She patted his head lightly.

Happy leapt out of bed to try and kick Brandy Jane in the face, but she was too fast for him. She had already sped out of the room.

"Come back!" yelled Happy angrily after her.

Brandy Jane stopped, but she didn't come back. She put her hands on her hips, stuck out her tongue, and uttered a shockingly childish chant which I am too refined to print here (if it can be said that I am refined; I have never quite broken the habit of scratching itches in obscene places). Happy echoed the chant mockingly. She growled ferociously and dashed away. Happy ran after her, but being in ridiculously poor shape he was unable to pursue her for long. He wheezed and clutched at his chest, his white T-shirt he was given to sleep in drenched with sweat. He couldn't believe he had been able to reach the end of the hallway that quickly! He congratulated himself for such an accomplishment, then thought about how hungry that long run had made him. His stomach growled at him, and he massaged it. "Sowwy, tummy-woo," he said in a grating tone. "I'm twying."

"Like %$#@ you are!" said his stomach (in his imagination).

"Don't swear at me!" said Happy, taken quite aback.

"Yeah, this is a children's book," I added. "You jerk!" I have already done the reader the great service of censoring the unfortunate word thought by Happy to be said by his stomach, and replacing them with vague symbols indicating an expletive.

"%$#@!" repeated Happy's stomach, angered by its being silenced in the narrative. "%$#@!"

Happy tried to bite his stomach, because biting something always solves any problems it is having. However, his neck was not of sufficient length to stretch to his stomach, and he became severely uncomfortable rather than having accomplished his goal.

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA AA" screamed Happy.

"What's going on down there?" bellowed a voice that Happy recognized as Serious'. *Uh-oh*. Happy gulped—"*gulpie!*"—and felt the hairs on the back of his neck stand up as Serious barreled towards him.

"How many times do I have to tell you that screaming is *not sigma*, Rotter?" cried Serious. "To breakfast with you, and I better not hear

another peep, or I'm reporting you to the Shearers!"

"*gulpie!*" gulped Happy gulpily. "Naw bruh, I'd win."

"You know what happens with the Shearers, don't you?" asked Serious, pushing him towards the hallway that led from the dormitories to the main school. "They take the sheep, and they shear them in the abattoir. Then they ship them out. And if you keep screaming like that, you may end up in that pile as well. To be ceremoniously BUTCHERED by the students of Warthogs."

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy. The observant reader will notice that this "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" contains one less "A" than before. Happy is growing more tolerant!

"You are *so* not sigma," muttered Serious, and gave him one final shove, sending him into the hall.

Happy limped to the cafeteria (as the shove had been quite hard, forcing him to the ground and twisting his ankle; he was now holding onto the walls for support). The food was almost all gone, except for something labelled

SHTEAK. Happy didn't know what SHTEAK was, and he wasn't entirely sure he cared to—it appeared to be nothing more than a pile of moldy potato peels, with misshapen, rusty nails sticking out the sides like crooked fingers.

"Want some SHTEAK?" asked the cook, a rather imposing woman with red curly hair trapped behind a hairnet. "Yes please!" chirped the girl in front of him, who was none other than

Brandy Jane. She appeared to have already eaten a good amount of SHTEAK (as was evidenced by the heap of potato peels on her tray) and was asking for seconds.

"Now dear, don't fill up on those nails. The potato peels are good, too, you know."

"Yeah," complained Brandy Jane, "I know, I know, but the nails are just so delicious! Give me more misshapen ones! The more misshapen, the more they crunch in my mouth! Mmm-mmm-mmm!"

"All right, dear, you may give your potato peels to Mud, over there." The cook pointed over to Katherine Neverbeen's usual table, where Katherine was heaping handfuls of cut

strawberries onto the muddy table, where they quickly disappeared—*or did they?*

"Hooray, hooray! Thanks, lady!" cried Brandy Jane as the cook slopped more SHTEAK onto her tray. After this was done, Brandy Jane took a potato peel from the stinking heap. Inspecting it carefully, she then replaced it, plunging her hand into the pile with an expression of utter delight plastered on her face. Her hand emerged clutching a ridiculously moldy and wet potato peel. It looked like a banana slug.

She walked over to Happy and put it ceremoniously upon his forehead.

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy. "GET IT OFF GET IT OFF PLEASE PLEASE GET IT OFF AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA GET IT OFF AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA GET IT OFF GET IT OFF!"

"Loser," said Brandy Jane, and slugged him.

Happy managed, after shaking his body like a wet dog for five full minutes, to get the potato peel onto the ground and off of his head.

"Littering is *not* a victimless crime, I'll have you know," said Brandy Jane in a holier-than-thou tone. "You'll be fined for that."

"I'm borkne," explained Happy. "I ain't got no money. Just give me my mah-nee!" he said, the last sentence in an odd, grating tone with odd stops.

"If you're broke, they'll break you."

"Whuh?!" said Happy.

"*Whut*?" Brandy Jane mimicked inaccurately.

I poked Brandy Jane. "He didn't say *whut*, you dummy," I told her, "he said *whuh. Hhh,* Brandy Jane, *hhh*!"

Brandy Jane exhaled loudly, informed me that I was a loser, and then made fun of my "*hhh*"ing. I kicked her in the shins. She became my FootSlug™. I shook her off, kicking her face in the process. She bit my leg. I bit her hair and pulled. She dug her nails into my arms. I dug *my* nails into *her* arms.

"I'm bored of writing about this," I said. "I quit."

Chapter Six

Biology is so boring, I think. I'm working on a dumb worksheet again. I was escaping into Happy Rotter when I got bored with it. OK, I have to do some noticings and wonderings. *Man*, I hate those! *Ugh!*

Maybe it would be better to write some more Happy Rotter. Maybe that will make me feel better.

Two weeks later, it's geometry, and I'm bored again. It's block classes and James Bond isn't helping me get through it—he's too busy falling for a trap by the Russian government, and Hercule Poirot would rather bore me to death than entertain me at present. I finished my assignment and have no way to correct the quiz I just received with the score of 8.5/10 (even though I *know* the correct answers and I *see* where I went wrong, there's a substitute today—interestingly enough, it's the same lady we had as a substitute for biology the week I quit—and the superfluous second teacher in the classroom is out helping someone else in the hall for reasons unfathomable, so no one can help me.)

But you know who I bet can help me? Brandy Jane!

"Yo," I say to Brandy Jane, starting time up again with her writhing on the floor as she searches desperately for my foot to latch onto once more, "entertain me. I'm bored!"

"Too bad for you, sucker!" she yells back at me. She then latches onto my foot and begins to bite it, like my cat likes to do. My cat can be a real jerk sometimes; at the time of writing, he's five moths old (intended!!! that was intended!!!!!) and a real terror, but he's an angel when he sleeps.

I remove myself from the situation and focus on Happy again.

Money, thought Happy. *Money, money, money,

I want some money. Then he began to whine (silently): *Why doesn't anybody let me scream? They're so mean at this school! I wanna go home! Home to Warthogs!*

For Warthogs (and he had only just now realized this) *was* his home, and the people in it his family. He wanted out of this house of hostile strangers who treated him so poorly. He wanted to scream—to shout—to roar—to vocalize his anger and pain—for me to think of another simile for "scream" so it will sound more poetic. Wait—wait—throatily agonize? Is that good? Maybe not...

"Pay the fine, dork," said Brandy Jane.

"Money, money, money," explained Happy.

"That's rich!" said Brandy Jane, then laughed at her own joke.

There was a scuttling noise which built to a crescendo as the Tax Rat appeared in front of them.

Please, somebody draw the Tax Rat. The Tax Rat is really cute: it's a rat with a little cap and it holds out the cap and it looks at you and you have to pay the fine and otherwise it bites you. Oh yeah, it also wears a little red

vest and it looks real cute transposed on its grey fur.

"Hello, Tax Rat," said Brandy Jane cordially.

"Goodbye, Tax Rat," retorted Happy discourteously.

The Tax Rat sniffed (as Happy had hurt her feelings) and her eyes filled with tears.

"She's going to report that to faculty," said Brandy Jane. "You don't want to be shorn, do you?"

"What's *shorn*?" asked Happy.

"It's sheared, but, like, grammatically correct, which you'd know, if you weren't stupid," explained Brandy Jane as though she was talking to a simpleton (which she was). The Tax Rat nodded in agreement as she spoke.

"Pay the tax," warned Brandy Jane.

"I'm borkne!"

"No, you're not."

The skin on Happy's throat fell off. He gave it to the Tax Rat. She scurried off, which is a shame because she was really fun to write. I like the Tax Rat. She's cute. There's one at Warthogs too, except that one is a boy and likes to go out drinking with his buddies.

Frequently hungover, he does not often report for work, but because he is so cute Rumbledoor lets it slide. *His* vest is green. They are vastly different.

"That's the kind of currency they're asking for." Brandy Jane nodded approvingly as she waved goodbye to the Tax Rat. "See, they don't need *money*. What use is there for money, here? What they need is something important to you, something you'd be sad to lose. Something that will be missed," she explained. "Like a human life."

"No one cared when I killed Claus," said Happy. "Did someone use his body as tax?"

"Almost certainly," said Brandy Jane. "Awesome, dude! You killed someone? Good job!" She slapped him on the back so hard that he fell over and the flesh of his throat began to further deteriorate. Happy blinked in shock. "*blinkie!*" And wouldn't you know it, Autocorrect changed "*blinkie!*" to "*blankie!*", although not the second time. You're learning, Autocorrect. You're learning...

It was time for Physical Education. "Remember, this exercise is OPTIONAL," hollered the Nameless One (as the class had been told to call the voice, when Jonah had the

courage to ask) from the loudspeakers. They were all doing jumping Jacks. All the people named Jack in the room (as well as a sheep called Jack from the shepherding class, whom Happy would have to herd back) had to jump for the entire class. It was optional... for those who weren't named Jack.

"I hate jumping Jacks," whined Happy. "It's boring."

"You can jump too," said the Nameless One, who had apparently heard Happy whining. The Nameless One knows all. The Nameless One sees all. The Nameless One *is* all. Ha, ha ha... *aaaaaa* ha ha ha ha ha... a ha ha ha ha **ha!!**

"No," said Happy, "I can't."

"Yes you can!" said the Nameless One encouragingly.

"I don't think so," said Happy.

"I think so," countered the Nameless One.

Happy kicked Jack (the people). Jack (the people) screamed. So did Jack (the sheep). So did Happy. They all screamed "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA", and it was a thing that happened.

"I'm bored of this again," I said. "Somebody do something!"

Just then, who should scurry in but the Tax Rat. "You'll pay for that scream!" boomed the Nameless One at Jack (the sheep). Jack (the sheep) bleated, terrified, and jumped onto the Tax Rat. She died instantly.

"Funeral's after school. Great work today, everybody!" boomed the Nameless One as a different Tax Rat (her twin?) came to take the Tax Rat's broken body away as tax.

Happy guided Jack (the sheep) to shepherding class. Jack (the sheep) was traumatized from the experience of killing, but the rush was wonderful. Jack (the sheep) wanted more. Jack (the sheep) longed to once again hear the sickening crack of bones breaking under his hooves. Jack (the sheep) wanted to kill. Bloodlust boiled in his heart. Suddenly he lunged at Happy.
"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" screamed Happy.
"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA"

"You'll pay for that scream," said Brandy Jane from behind him.

"Brandy Jane!" screamed Happy. "You gotta help me!"

"OK!" She smiled, took out a knife from behind her back, and stuck it into Jack's back.
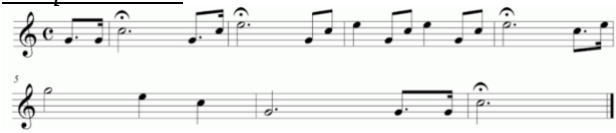
"INSOLENT CHILDREN" the voice of Delicious reverberated throughout the hallway. "KILLING ONE OF THE SACRED SHEEP, YOU WILL BE *DEALT WITH*. AFTER THE TAX RAT'S FUNERAL, YOU WILL BE SENT TO THE SHEARERS."

"*gaspie!*" said Happy gaspily.

"*gaspie!*" said Brandy Jane, quite out of character.

"*gaspie!*" said Jack (the sheep) as his soul leaked out of his body. It was the last (and first) word he ever said.

Chapter Seven



went Brandy Jane's bugle.

"A noble soul, gone too soon," intoned Delicious. "The both of them."

Each and every Prazkaban student was standing on the lawn in pitch black clothing with their heads bowed in front of a miniscule coffin and a gigantic coffin. The coffins of the Tax Rat and Jack (the sheep).

"Isoners, pay your—er, students, say goodbye to your dear friends."

"What's an *isoner*?" Happy asked Brandy Jane.

"That's what we are," said Brandy Jane, and her face darkened. "That's what Prazkaban does. You can't leave without dying, but at least you're not sad about it. It's not a good school, but it's not a bad school. It just... *is*, and so are you. You're not a prisoner. You're an *i*soner."

Happy blinked—"*blinkie*!"—because he didn't understand. Autocorrect understood,

however, and didn't change "*blinkie!*" to "*blankie!*" either time!

"You two!" barked Delicious. Brandy Jane saluted and folded her bugle back into her bright pink pants pocket.

"Why are you wearing pink when everybody's wearing black? That's sus, bruh," said Happy.

"Death is something to celebrate!" explained Brandy Jane. "Death is great! Death is nice. More despicable organisms have ceased to operate! That's all it is! How awesome, how wonderful!"

Happy eyed Brandy Jane with a modicum of distrust.

"HAPPY! BRANDY JANE!" bellowed Delicious. "COME HERE THIS INSTANT!"

When they scurried (Happy reluctantly, Brandy Jane excitedly) to his side, Delicious barked, "Follow me!" He brought them to an old shack all the way across the lawn, Happy complaining all the way about his legs and his arms and his stomach and his head and his nose and his eyes and his ears and his hands and his feet and his fingers and his toes. No

one made him shut up. It was too late for him. They all knew that.

They finally arrived at the derelict abattoir. The sheep were being led in by Professor Quarrel and Maddy as well. "Fancy meeting *you* here!" said Delicious in a humorous tone. Professor Quarrel chuckled.

"Hi, Mr. Quarrel," said Happy loudly. "Hi Maddy."

"Forget about the Shearers. I'll kill him myself," said Maddy.

"Kill!" screeched Brandy Jane. "Kill, kill, kill-kill-kill. To kill—*death*!" She raced around Happy as though she were a vulture and he already dead.

"Stop it, Brandy Jane!" commanded Delicious. "Don't make me use my daddy voice!"

"Kill, kill, kill-kill-kill," chirruped Brandy Jane. "To kill—*death!*" and she threw Professor Quarrel and Maddy at Delicious. They shoved both her and Happy into the abattoir.

What struck Brandy Jane first was the jazz cassette. She doubled over, screeching, and covered her ears, her knuckles turning white.

"TURN IT OFF" she screeched. "TURN IT OFF"

Happy began to do a silly dance. Tears leaked from Brandy Jane's squeezed-shut eyes. "OH COD OH TURN IT OFF" she yelled.

Happy looked around for a phone, but there was none. Just this weird black thingie with some buttons. Happy pushed all the buttons at once and it made an angry noise and something came out of it. The jazz music stopped. Brandy Jane stopped. The sheep stopped.

There were thudding footsteps, heading downstairs. As they accelerated, so did Happy's pulse.

"Die," said the vacant-eyed boy. It was Claus.

And all the dead bodies followed after him.

"Zombies!" screamed Happy. "Run!" He stood there. "Run!" he said again. "Run!" he said a third time. He still didn't move.

Finally he turned towards the door to see Maddy lying on the floor bleeding out from Delicious' horrible wrath. In her limp hand was a cane.

And not just any cane...

There was a shrill chattering noise and out streamed a veritable crusade of ~~wood~~ pill bugs. "For our noble comrade!" cried Filbert. "For our noble comrade!" echoed the rest of the ~~w~~ pill bugs. They swarmed the dead children with their vacant eyes. As Maddy joined their ranks, soon she too was knocked down.

"Baaaa" bleated Jeff plaintively. "Jeff!" cried Happy.

"It's—" stuttered Brandy Jane. "It's—"

"What?" asked Happy snidely.

"It's all the dead children. All the tax," said Brandy Jane. "Look, Happy, there's your throat." She pointed. Happy looked. "Aw man!" said Happy. "These kids were all killed, and now they're Shearers. What a fate!" She grinned. "Kill, kill, kill-kill-kill. To kill—*death*!"

The Shearers weren't to be controlled, however. Claus (who appeared to have taken on a sort of leadership role within their ranks), squashed two of the pill bugs—there was a general chorus of "There goes Bill!" and "They got Suzie!" and the pill bugs retreated on Filbert's command. Then, he went towards a closet and rolled out a dusty Radio Flyer wagon x1000 size. He set the wagon GPS and

began picking up the sheep and hauling them in there. Happy, who loved to look over shoulders, looked over Claus' shoulder and saw where the destination had been set to.

Warthogs!

"C'mon, Happy, let's get out—" began Brandy Jane, but stopped when she noticed Happy clambering onto Jeff's back and picking up the cane. "Happy! What are you doing?"

"I'm going home," said Happy petulantly. Anticipation—gleeful anticipation—filled his heart.

"ME ALSO!" screeched Brandy Jane, and leaped onto the back of a sheep Happy recalled was named Belinda. The sheep were filed onto the wagon, and eventually it was Jeff and Belinda's turn.

The wagon rocked and swayed as the great gates at the back of the abattoir thundered open. Claus gave the wagon a push to get it moving, and they were off.

Off to Warthogs. Out of Prazkaban. Isoners no more. Happy and Brandy Jane were free.

Surely, thought Happy, *I'll never see Delicious Foulmouth again.*

He will.
And don't call me Shirley.
The End.

cast of characters

Happy Rotter: A small, unpleasant eleven-year-old boy, Happy is the protagonist of the series. Parallel in *Harry Potter:* Harry

Herminey: Herminey is the angry ImPerfect which Happy and Nor continually avoid, as she whips them whenever they use slang. She has blond hair. Parallel in *Harry Potter:* Hermione

Morris Weasel: Happy's best friend, Morris ("Nor") Weasel is a red-haired twelve-year-old boy who loves using slang as well as inventing ridiculous words. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Ron

Codra Foulmouth: Rumbledoor's henchperson, whom Happy once knew only as Aggressive Silver due to his shiny hair. He actually has a soft spot for slang due to his traumatic childhood (his parents never let him on electronics!) Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Malfoy

Looney Mooney: Looney Mooney isn't quite right in the head; her first language was Chiligriti and sometimes interjections from it appear in her dialogue. She has a fondness for slang as well. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Luna

Kathy Cook: Kathy Cook is the replacement for Kendal Cook, who was fired the day before the book begins. She likes talking a lot. She also likes slang. Parallel in *Harry Potter:* None

Ronald: Twins with Donald, Ronald enjoys hamburgers and lying to stupid people. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: None

Donald: Twins with Ronald, Donald enjoys hamburgers and lying to stupid people. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: None

Ginger Weasel: Sister to Nor, red-haired ten-year-old Ginny is an impressionable child who takes on the speech patterns of the characters in the book she reads. This summer, Mrs. Weasel's had her on Shakespeare. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Ginny

Rumbledoor: The menacing headmaster of Warthogs, Rumbledoor is a door that rumbles. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Dumbledore

Professor Snake: The *ssstrict sssupervisssor* (as he would say) of the ivy mines, Professor Snake—a literal green snake—believes he speaks in Parseltongue, but is actually just speaking English with elongated 'sss' sounds. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Snape

Professor McGowan: The other teacher at Warthogs, Professor McGowan is a small goose who teaches insolent pupils how to work their jobs. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Professor McGonagall

Hairy Otter: The beloved mascot of Warthogs, Hairy Otter enjoys catching fish in the dirty river. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: None

OSWALD the LUCKY RABBIT: Permitted to appear in the series due to his being in the public domain, OSWALD is Warthogs' resident poltergeist. But is he just there to cause trouble, or something more? Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Peeves

Mrs. Solace: Mrs. Solace is the school custodian, a black cat who can talk. In her spare time, she enjoys playing with her pet human, Mr. Flinch. Parallel in *Harry Potter:* Mrs. Norris

Mr. Flinch: Mr. Flinch is Mrs. Solace's pet human. He is dumb in both senses of the word. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Filch

Brandy Jane: Happy's annoying dweeb extraordinaire classmate at Prazkaban. Ugh! What a smart-aleck! Parallel in *Harry Potter*: None

Delicious Foulmouth: Codra's father, a strict man who is the headmaster of Prazkaban. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Lucius

Serious White: Happy's "designated friend" in Prazkaban, he turns out to be a real jerk. Parallel in *Harry Potter*: Sirius

Now, have a sneak peek at book four in this enchanting series, *Happy Rotter and the Foblet of Gyre*, publishing soon...

Chapter One

The obscenely large Radio Flyer wagon rolled through Warthogs' gates. Happy gripped the red-rimmed sides violently and felt the wind caress his face—the sweet, sweet wind of the Northern region of the undefined land in which Warthogs lay (although Happy didn't know which direction was north, or south, or where Warthogs was, or even what country he lived in, and neither shall you).

The unmistakable sound of the noiseless gates attracted Codra Foulmouth to the entrance of Warthogs, like moth to flame. "Hwhah?" he said at first as the sight of the obscenely large Radio Flyer. "Ehh?!" he said second as he noticed what was on it: Happy Rotter. "Waah!" he said third as he ducked under the wagon onto the grass, for he was about to be rolled over.

With the hiss of hydraulics (even though it did not use hydraulics), the Radio Flyer came to a stop. "You have now reached your destination," explained the GPS embedded

onto its side. "The route guidance is now finished."

The route guidance had been a lot of helpful life advice ("remember, you can be anything!: even a murderer"; "don't forget, if at first you don't succeed... it's only *attempted* murder"; "keep your feet on the stars and keep reaching for the ground", etc., etc.). Happy shed no tears at its demise.

The GPS was promptly consumed by Pliny the Elder, the sprightliest lamb in the herd. There were disturbing crunching noises and something that sounded a lot like a tormented wail as the small device and its strap disappeared into the lamb's oral cavity. "Chomp smack," explained Pliny the Elder. "Nummers."

Happy blinked. "*blinkie!* Surely it doesn't taste *that* good."

The crack of a whip met him from a cave on his right, from which a girl with blond hair emerged. She wore a furious expression, which melted slightly the second she saw Happy. "Don't call me Shirley," Herminey commanded viciously, but slowly, almost imperceptibly, her face was turning into a grin. Not only that, but it was beginning to redden

like a time-lapse video Happy had seen on TikTok once of a ripening tomato. Happy knew she enjoyed tormenting him, but this seemed different, somehow. Not enjoyment, more... what was the word? It began with an *e*, and he could never spell it correctly... well, it probably didn't matter.

"M-m-my father says" Codra opened his mouth and emitted a high-pitched, intermittent beeping noise. "Yeah, he's angry."

"Bruh," said Happy.

It was that precise moment that Brandy Jane chose to clamber out of the wagon, shoving Happy out of the way and jumping clear off the side.

"Who's the rizzler?" said Nor, who had appeared from the dark cave entrance.

"Care to repeat that?" said Herminey.

"Yeah, rizzy skibidi," Happy squawked.

"Avert thine eyes /," commanded Ginger, who had emerged as well and shoved Herminey aside. "I shall take it upon mineself / To fulfill this most honorable duty."

"Your iambic pentameter is impressive," remarked Brandy Jane. "Who are you guys again? Also: where am I and what's happening?"

"Cackle cackle," Pliny the Elder reassured her.

"Thanks, that means a lot," said Brandy Jane, and no one could tell whether she was being sarcastic or not.

"Thine ignorance must be right'd /," Ginger decreed, "Else thine eyes shall remain / Forever clouded, lost / In the dusty sands of regret."

"Oh noooooo," said Nor sarcastically. "I'm so scared for you, random lady."

"Lady?" said Brandy Jane all loud. "I'm twelve years old."

"That's great, lady," said Nor. "Why don't you help us out and mine?"

"Mine?" shrieked Brandy Jane. "*Mine?!* Such great intellectual talents as mine have no right to be neglected in this horrid manner! I demand to see your manager, young man."

"You mean Rumbledoor?" asked Codra squeakily.

"Who?"

"He came from Forceps. You know, like you did. You should remember him, he was only removed last year."

"What's Forceps?"

Codra blinked. "My father's school. The school you were just at. Forceps School for Incurables." He broke into a coughing fit.

"Shaddup!" commanded Herminey, cracking her whip.

"We were at Prazkaban," stated Brandy Jane. "I don't know what the h-e-double-hockey-sticks you're talking about."

"Prazkaban... is that what they're calling it now?" asked Herminey.

"You mean we were at where *you* went to school the entire time? Gheesh, I'm glad we got out!" said Happy loudly.

"What did you say!" yelled Herminey. Her face was red with agitation now. "Say it one more time!!"

"Break it up," came an airy voice from the steps, and out of the heavy door stepped Looney Mooney. Happy's blood boiled and his hands curled into fists at his side. *She did this. It's her fault I went to Prazkaban. It's her fault.*

He thought back to when he had killed Claus. Thought back to how *easy* it was.

yeeeeeeeeeeeees it had been so *easy*...

"Oh!" said Looney Mooney brightly. "Are those the sheep for the ceremony?"

"Yes," said Brandy Jane, "indeed they are."

Herminey's face twisted itself into something akin to a smile. "I love slaughtering those guys!"

"EEP!" yelped every single sheep as one.

"Kill, kill, kill-kill-kill," sang Brandy Jane. "To kill—*death*!"

"'Tis a most peculiar tune / Which flows from thine ever-mobile lips," observed Ginger.

"To kill—*death!*" squawked Brandy Jane again.

"Bruh," called Nor to Happy, "turnin' on the rizz, yo!"

Herminey pounced. She pinned Nor to the ground and began relentlessly punching him. Once both of his canine teeth had flown from his bloody lips, she relented and whipped him once on the stomach. Nor squealed like a fat pig and writhed on the ground (she had left his every appendage bruised, causing extreme pain to flare in his chest whenever he moved).

"I'd b-b-better take you to s-s-see Rumbledoor," squeaked Codra to Brandy Jane. He then violently seized her arm. "Oi!" yelled Brandy Jane. "You'll be fined for this, I'll have you know!" She went boneless. Codra dragged her by both her arms up the stairs (she made gulping noises as she was dragged up each step)

and through the doors into the hallway. *scrapescrapescrapescrape* went Brandy Jane's scratchy sweater onto the odd tiling of the Warthogs floors. The sound gradually faded as Codra made his way to the headmaster's office.

"Well!" said Herminey loudly, once the scratching could no longer be heard. "It's time for you to get mining, Happy!" She tossed his pickaxe at him, causing a gaping wound on the side of his arm. A bit of flesh fell off, exposing the bone. "Sniffle sob!" said Happy, then screamed "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA". The observant reader will notice that this "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA" contains one less "A" than before. Happy is growing more tolerant!

It felt good to let loose. Despite the pain, Happy smiled.

Thank you for reading *Happy Rotter and the Isoner of Prazkaban*, a parody of *Harry Potter and the Prisoner of Azkaban* by JK Rowling. If you enjoyed this book, please pass it on to one of your friends, preferably someone in a position of power so they can spread the seed. Spread the seed, dear reader, spread the seed.

—The Mysterious CEO of Black Cat Press